



DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

COURSE REPORT FOR FIRST CYCLE COURSES IN POLITICAL SCIENCE

The aim of the course report is to demonstrate responsiveness towards the students' views, guarantee the quality of the course, and stimulate subject related and pedagogical development. The report should have a forward-looking focus and be based on the course coordinator's own reflections and input received from students (individually or in groups), teaching staff, education administrators, and the study counsellor, as well as the course evaluation.

Course name: Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) Course code: SK1136 Semester: Autumn Semester 2025		Course coordinator (name and e-mail address): Lisbeth Aggestam lisbeth.aggestam@gu.se
Brief description of course content and structure	The course is part of the International Politics track in the second year of the Political Science Program. It is also taught to Erasmus and free-standing students. The course introduces students to Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) as a distinct subfield of International Politics, providing theoretical and conceptual tools to explain foreign policy. Students are expected to learn to apply different FPA theories and models of foreign policy decision-making to empirical cases and to describe the foreign policy-making process and implementation. Teaching includes lectures and seminars with written and oral components.	
Completion rate and grades	Out of 34 registered students (two withdrawals), 26 students had completed the course by March 2026. 13 students received a High Pass, and 13 students received a Pass.	
General and specific impressions of the course	The course structure is well-established and works well with a combination of teaching methods, including interactive lectures and seminars that include group presentations by students.	
Students' general impressions of the course	The response rate on the course evaluation was low with 11 out of 34 registered students responding. 8 out of 11 students rated the course 'rather good to very good' (72,8%).	
Students' impressions of specific elements of the course	<i>Lectures</i> were well received (72,8%) and 81,9% of students rated teachers 'rather to very good'. In terms of the contents of the lectures, some students found FPA theories challenging to grasp and apply, particularly in their final research paper.	

	The format of <i>student-led seminars</i> with oral presentation and discussion is appreciated by students with 8 out of 11 students rating them ‘rather to very good’. Apart from the intellectual learning experience, these seminars are intended to practice generic skills of group teamwork and presentation. Some students found the reading and preparation of group work demanding. Students are satisfied (77,4% rather to very good) with the <i>course literature</i>, particularly the FPA textbook by Oppermann and Brummer (2024) but some students complained that it was difficult to purchase the book at the Campus bookshop and that there were not enough copies in the Library though it should be noted that this is the number of books set by the University Library. In terms of <i>workload</i>, five students found the workload OK while five students found it somewhat/too demanding.														
Impressions of students’ and teachers’ views on the administration of the course, incl. Canvas	The course organization and administration ran smoothly and 8 out of 11 students considered it ‘rather to very good’.														
Ideas of potential changes for the next round	Based on the student evaluation and feedback, the following changes will be made next time the course is running: • Explain in the first introductory lecture more explicitly the purpose of theory and outline the logic of the FPA ‘tool-kit’ that forms the backbone of the course. • Review the number of articles to be read for each seminar. • Revising the instructions for the final research essay to a choice of specific essay titles.														
Ideas of long-term and/or more comprehensive changes	The fast-moving developments and impact of AI on teaching require continuous reflection on forms of assessment and activities. • Replace the final research paper with a written exam to be introduced in the autumn of 2026. • Maintain compulsory seminars with group presentations but remove individual seminar papers.														
Other comments	From the course evaluation question: ”Overall, how do you assess the course?” <table><tr><td></td><td>VT25</td><td>HT25</td><td>VT26</td><td>HT26</td><td>VT27</td><td>HT27</td></tr><tr><td>Means</td><td>2,1</td><td>2,2</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr></table> Note: Five-point scale on which 1 corresponds to very good and 5 to very bad.		VT25	HT25	VT26	HT26	VT27	HT27	Means	2,1	2,2				
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